Chapter 7

Finding Job Security in an AI World

IN THIS CHAPTER

- **Looking at new AI job roles**
- **AI-proofing your skills**
- **Avoiding pitfalls**

AI is changing how people work, but it can't replace human skills like emotional intelligence, creativity, and strategic thinking. This chapter looks at how to upgrade your skills for jobs that AI can't do. It also explains how to use your current skills in new ways for these jobs and how to stay ahead in the near future when AI is more commonplace.

Identifying Tasks That AI Can't Replace

Even as AI continues to develop, humans will still be able to do certain tasks better. AI capabilities are becoming more advanced, but humans have strengths and abilities that are difficult, at this point, to replicate with technology.

These strengths and abilities include emotional understanding, creativity, and strategic insight. This section highlights the enduring value of human skills that AI has difficulty achieving. We also look at how you can secure your place in an AI-driven future with these skills.

Cultivating emotional intelligence and human interaction

Emotional intelligence (EQ) is, in part, the ability to recognize and respond to the emotions of others. It's a key element for getting along with people, whether at work or in other parts of life. Although AI is smart in many ways, it doesn't fully understand or show emotions the way that humans can.

You use EQ every day, and it's critical for working well with others. In any job, how you talk to and understand your co-workers and clients really matters. Think about a team leader or a salesperson — they need to be good at reading people's feelings. This is something AI can't do yet. AI can give us facts and figures, but it doesn't understand how people *feel*.

Similarly, when you don't agree with someone, EQ helps you sort things out. It helps you see both sides and understand how everyone feels. This is extremely important in jobs like counseling or when you need to smooth over a problem with a customer. AI tools may help with some aspects, but those tools don't understand the finer points of making peace between people.



which helps everyone work better together. Thinking like a leader is something AI can't do. Leadership is about really getting to *know* people, not just what the data says.

As AI is used more frequently, you need to be skilled in understanding and showing emotions. This ensures that you'll remain central to the process, even when AI is handling the details. Additionally, it makes your work and life more meaningful because you connect with people in more genuine ways.

Sparking creative and strategic thinking

In the workplace, two of the most valuable human skills are creativity and strategic thinking. Unlike AI, humans have the unique ability to come up with original ideas and solve complex problems in innovative ways.

Now consider why these skills are so important. Understanding this will show you how to keep your edge over AI in particular areas of work.

- **Creative thinking** is about seeing things in new ways. It's the skill that drives innovation and breakthroughs. When you think creatively, you aren't just following a set pattern; you're making something new. This could be anything from designing a stunning piece of art to developing a groundbreaking business strategy.

  TIP AI, with its current technology, is good at processing information and identifying patterns, but it doesn't truly create in the same way humans do. AI may mix and match what it knows, but coming up with something completely new is a human trait.

  For example, consider a marketing team brainstorming a campaign. They're not just looking at data; they're using their creativity to tell a story that resonates with people. AI can analyze past successful campaigns, but the spark of creating a new, engaging idea comes from human minds. That's because humans understand emotions, cultural nuances, and the subtleties of humor and wit, which are essential in marketing.
- **Strategic thinking** is about planning to achieve a goal. It involves looking ahead, understanding the big picture, and making decisions. These decisions are based on this mix of knowledge and insight. Humans do well at considering these types of factors, including potential risks and opportunities.

  REMEMBER People can then decide on a course of action based on the interpretation of these factors. AI can help with decision-making by providing data-driven insights. However, the ability to examine different options and anticipate possible outcomes is a distinctly human skill.

  Consider a company CEO deciding the business's direction. The CEO has to evaluate market trends, company strengths, and competitor actions. Global economic factors may also play a role. AI tools can supply data on these factors that help inform a decision. It's the human ability for strategic thinking, though, that can interpret the data, understand the implications, and make decisions that align with long-term goals.

In fields like developing new products, running businesses, and creating art, creative and strategic thinking are vital. These abilities allow you to do more than fix problems. They let you imagine what it could be and

then work to make it happen. As people start to use AI more in their jobs, it's becoming clearer how important creative and strategic capabilities are. These human skills are what make businesses grow, change for the better, and succeed.



REMEMBER As you adopt AI into your workflow, it's important to remember that creative and strategic thinking are skills that drive progress and new ideas. Even in an environment where AI is ubiquitous, these unique human contributions are still essential and extremely valuable. This balance between human skills and AI shows that both have their place in moving us forward.

Engaging in jobs of the future

As AI becomes more common in the workplace, it's important to look at the jobs it may affect and the ones it won't. AI is great at many things, but there are still jobs where human skills are more important. These jobs rely on the ability to understand people, be creative, and think ahead.

Here are the types of jobs that will be important in the future and the skills you need to succeed in them:

- **Jobs that require the ability to understand people's feelings:** These include roles like counselors, social workers, and human resource professionals. AI can handle a lot of information, but it doesn't really understand how people *feel*. In these jobs, being able to connect with others and understand their problems is something only humans can do well.
- **Creative jobs:** This category includes artists, designers, and people who work in entertainment. These jobs focus on creating new things. AI can help, but really new and original ideas come from people. Humans use their imagination and experiences to create art, design new things, and entertain others.
- **Jobs in business and management:** People in these roles have to plan for the future and make decisions that benefit their company. They need to think about things like what their competitors are doing and what customers want. AI can give them information, but making these critical decisions requires human thought.

- **Healthcare jobs:** Health care is another area where humans are very important. Doctors, nurses, and other healthcare workers do more than treat illnesses. They also care about their patients and understand their needs. AI can suggest treatments, but it's the healthcare workers who provide the care and support patients need.
- **Teachers:** Teachers play a key role that AI can't replace. They don't just teach; they inspire and understand their students. AI can help make learning easier, but the encouragement and guidance that teachers provide are things only humans can offer.
- **Jobs in research and development of new products:** These jobs involve finding out new things and making new technologies. Humans are curious and come up with questions that lead to discoveries, something AI isn't able to do. Developing these skills will help you be ready for a future where AI is more common.

Discovering new roles that use AI

In the future, as AI becomes a more significant part of work, new kinds of jobs will be created. These jobs will work *with* AI and require that the jobholders make sure AI aligns with a company's goals and interests.

The roles that will be in greater demand will require people who are

- **Experts at integrating AI into different parts of a business:** These AI integration specialists will know a lot about technology and how businesses run. They'll help deploy AI tools in a way that works best for a given business.
- **Equipped to function as AI ethicists:** They'll use AI in ways that are appropriate and free of bias. They'll understand the rules of AI and help companies use it without harming customers or exposing the company to other liabilities.
- **Able to manage how AI and humans work together:** They'll focus on optimizing the human–AI workflow. These managers will make sure that both people and AI are doing what they do best.
- **Experts in data privacy:** As AI uses more information, keeping this data safe will be an important job. People in these roles will protect personal information and make sure the company follows privacy laws.



TIP These new jobs show just a sample of how AI is creating more new opportunities. These jobs of the future will combine business, techni-

cal, and interpersonal skills to solve problems and work with others.

Upskilling for AI-Proof Jobs

In the near future, AI will likely replace some people's jobs and empower others. This latter group will be the people who learn to use AI and turn it into an asset that makes them better at what they do. To become one of these people, you need to learn how to use the AI tools that will make you irreplaceable. Improving your skills will put you in a position to take advantage of future career opportunities.

DOING A SKILLS INVENTORY AND GAP ANALYSIS

Understanding your current skills and identifying what you need to learn is essential for thriving in a future where AI plays a big role. This process is called a *skills inventory and gap analysis*. It looks at what you're good at and helps you determine what skills you need to develop.

Let's look at the steps needed to do this effectively and why it's crucial for your career growth:

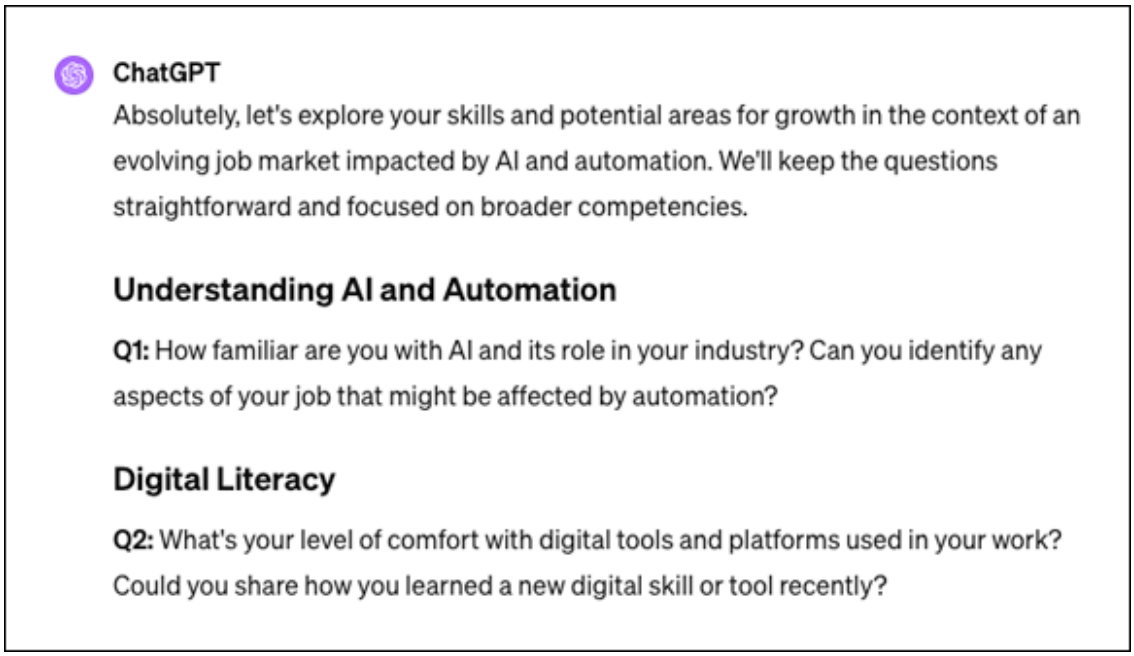
1. **Conduct a skills inventory.**
   This entails listing all the skills you have. Think about everything you know how to do, from your work experience, education, and even daily life activities. Your skills may include things like communicating well, solving problems, or understanding new technology. This step is like taking a good look at what tools you have in your toolbox right now.
2. **Analyze your skill gaps.**
   This is where you compare your skills with those needed for future jobs, especially in fields in which AI will be used extensively. To find out what skills you may be missing, you can check job listings, read about industry trends, and see what skills experts say will be important. The goal is to identify the skills you don't yet have but will need. These may be technical skills, like learning to use certain software, or soft skills, like being good at working with a team.
   Why is understanding your skills and gaps so important? Even though AI is really helpful, it can't do everything. Jobs that need human creativity, understanding, and leadership are becoming more common. By knowing your skills and the areas you need to improve, you can focus on becoming better in ways that AI cannot. This makes you a more attractive choice for employers.
3. **Make a list of what you want to do.**

Research the skills that are in demand in your industry or the industry you want to move into. Look for patterns in job ads and industry news. What skills keep coming up that you don't have? Maybe it's understanding AI tools or getting better at creative thinking.

4. **Make a plan to fill your skill gaps.**
   This could involve online courses, workshops, or practice in your current job. ***Remember:*** The goal is not to be perfect at everything but to be ready to learn and adapt.

If you're having trouble identifying your skills and gaps, you can have AI help you. Try using a prompt such as, "Can we do a simple Q&A to help me understand my current skills and where I may need to improve to stay relevant in a job market that's increasingly influenced by AI? I'm not very technical, so I'd appreciate questions that don't require deep tech knowledge but still help me think about adapting to a future where many tasks may be automated."

That prompt would tell the AI to give you a set of questions, as shown in the following figure, which help you discover what your skills and gaps are.



ChatGPT

Absolutely, let's explore your skills and potential areas for growth in the context of an evolving job market impacted by AI and automation. We'll keep the questions straightforward and focused on broader competencies.

Understanding AI and Automation

Q1: How familiar are you with AI and its role in your industry? Can you identify any aspects of your job that might be affected by automation?

Digital Literacy

Q2: What's your level of comfort with digital tools and platforms used in your work? Could you share how you learned a new digital skill or tool recently?

By doing a skills inventory and gap analysis, you're preparing yourself for a future where AI is common at work. It's a way to show that you can work with AI and bring valuable skills to your job.

Translating Your Current Skills into AI-Proof Roles

In the previous section, we examine how you can gain new skills. In this section, we take a closer look at how you can transition these skills into AI-proof roles. As you adapt to an AI-enhanced work environment, it's important to understand how your skills fit into this new landscape.

You need to recognize the value of your skills and figure out how to apply them. We look at how to reshape and apply your abilities in ways that complement AI, ensuring that your skills stay relevant and in demand.

Analyzing skills transferability

As industries rapidly embrace AI, it's important to know how you can use your existing skills in new ways. This process, called *skill transferability analysis*, refers to understanding which of your skills can be applied to AI-resistant roles.



TIP Skill transferability focuses on the importance of being versatile and adaptable. It's the ability to use skills from one area in another area. For example, if you're good at solving problems in your current job, that skill can transfer to a different job, too, even if it's in a new field.

To conduct this analysis:

- **List the skills you use in your current job.** These may be hard skills, like specific technical abilities, or soft skills, like communication or teamwork. When you have your list, think about how each skill could be useful in other areas. For example, suppose you're good at organizing things and managing time. In that case, these skills are valuable in project management roles, which are less likely to be automated by AI.
- **List the skills that are in demand in jobs where AI is used.** These may include understanding how to work with AI tools, data analysis, or digital marketing. Compare these in-demand skills with your current skills. Where do they

match? This overlap shows where you're already prepared for AI-resistant roles.

As in the earlier example about doing a skills and gaps analysis (see the "Doing a skills inventory and gap analysis" sidebar), you can also use an AI tool like ChatGPT to help you brainstorm your skill transferability. Try a prompt like,

> *"Can you give me some questions to think about how the skills I'm good at could be used in different kinds of jobs, especially because a lot of jobs are changing because of computers and smart technology?"*

This prompt will get you on the right track toward understanding how your skills can be applied in different roles and contexts.



REMEMBER Versatility and adaptability are crucial here. Being versatile means having a range of skills that you can use in different situations. Adaptability requires being open to learning new things and changing how you work. In an AI-driven job market, versatility and adaptability are valuable qualities. They demonstrate that you can keep up with changes and fit into different roles as needed.

Table 7-1 shows an example of a skills transferability analysis.

TABLE 7-1 Example Skills Transferability Analysis

Current Skill	*Description*	*AI-Resistant Roles*	*Skill Transfer*
Conflict resolution	Managing and resolving disputes effectively	HR manager, mediator in AI ethics	Vital for roles in which understanding human emotions and finding common ground are key,

Current Skill	*Description*	*AI-Resistant Roles*	*Skill Transfer*
			especially in ethical considerations of AI usage.
Crisis management	Managing and resolving emergencies in business settings	AI risk manager, business continuity planner	Essential roles that require quick thinking and effective solutions in critical situations, especially in which AI systems may not predict unforeseen events.
Cultural sensitivity	Understanding and respecting diverse cultural perspectives in business	AI ethics advisor, international business developer	Valuable for roles that involve ensuring AI tools and products are culturally sensitive and adaptable to various global markets.

To improve your versatility and adaptability, try to learn new things regularly. This doesn't always mean formal training — it can be as simple as taking on a new task at work or learning a new tool. The more you learn, the more skills you have to offer.



REMEMBER The goal of skill transferability analysis is not to start over but to build on what you already know. You want to see your skills in a new

light and understand how they can be valuable in a changing job market. By doing this, you'll be ready for new roles that AI can't replace, and you'll keep your career moving forward.

Understanding role evolution and adaptation

AI will facilitate a role evolution. This means that your job duties today may be different tomorrow. In the following section, we explore how you can adapt your current skills to meet these new demands.

In some jobs, AI can do tasks that were once done by people, like analyzing data or scheduling appointments. This doesn't mean these jobs will disappear. Instead, the focus of these roles will shift. For example, a data analyst may spend less time collecting data (because AI can do that) and more time interpreting the data and making decisions based on it.

It also means focusing more on the skills AI can't do, like creative thinking, understanding people, and making complex decisions. For example, if you're in marketing, you may use AI to analyze customer trends, but you'll use your creativity to design campaigns that appeal to those customers.

So, how can you adapt your skills to these changing roles? Start by learning about the AI tools used in your field. Fortunately, it just so happens that you have before you an excellent resource for gaining a broad understanding of how to use AI:

- **Book 2** of this *All-In-One* guide goes into depth about prompting GenAI models.
- **Books 3 through 6** teach you about using GenAI in different situations and for various kinds of work.
- **Book 7** helps you learn how to customize GenAI applications and start to build AI agents to help you with various tasks.

Also, think about the parts of your job that need a human touch, like building relationships, solving unexpected problems, or coming up with new ideas. Focusing on these areas will help you stay important in your job, even as AI takes on more tasks.



TIP The goal is not to compete with AI but to work with it. By adapting your skills, you can make AI a tool that helps you do your job better, not something that replaces you. This is all about growing with the changes, not just trying to keep up.

Presenting the AI-resilient career journey

As AI becomes a big part of many jobs, figuring out how to move into careers that AI can't take over is important. This shift to AI-resistant roles needs careful planning and a positive approach.

Follow these steps to approaching an AI-proof career:

1. **Look at what you're good at and how these skills can fit into jobs that AI won't affect.**
   This means thinking about your strong points and how they match jobs that need a human touch, like understanding people or being creative. Jobs in health care or education or roles that need you to make big decisions are good examples.
2. **Find out more about jobs that AI will not likely change.**
   Healthcare, education, and creative fields are areas where human interaction, vision, and individuality can be very important. Search for jobs in these fields where your skills are valuable.
3. **Work on learning more about these AI-proof careers.**
   You may need to take some classes or workshops or even try out these jobs through volunteering. Keep up with what's new in these fields and how AI is being used. This way, you can be prepared for what's coming.



TIP Networking is a key part of changing careers. Meet people who work in the field you're interested in. Go to events, join online groups, and talk about the future of work with AI. Building a network can open up new chances and give you support while you're making this change.

Be ready to learn a lot of new things. Changing careers can be tough, but keep a positive attitude. Be open to new experiences and learn from both

the good and the bad. And think about how this career change will affect your life, like your money and how you spend your time. Make sure this new career fits with what you want in the long run. It isn't just about finding a job that's safe from AI — it's also about doing work that you like and that uses your skills.



REMEMBER Moving to an AI-resistant career means knowing your skills, learning new things, making connections, and planning well. By doing these things, you can smoothly move into a career where you can work alongside AI, not be replaced by it.

Navigating Career Transitions

In this section, we look at how to move into new AI-related jobs smoothly. We use examples to show how using your skills in new ways can open great opportunities for you. You may not be transitioning to the specific careers we use as examples, but you can extrapolate this information to whatever career you have in mind.

Adapting to new realities

AI tools are bringing new and incredible capabilities to a variety of professions. These capabilities include boosting productivity and assisting with creativity. Tasks that may have taken hours before can now be done in seconds. As more and more professionals adopt AI into their daily workflow, this impact is becoming more profound.

One profession, in particular, that has seen early and significant change is writing. Take, for example, copywriters. These professionals write copy for things like ads, blog content, and marketing emails. AI can help them outline early drafts of posts, find better words, and tailor a message for a specific audience. It can also critique the copywriter's work, so that they get feedback on the fly.

Figure 7-1 shows an example prompt a copywriter might use to have AI critique a draft blog post. This helps ensure the post achieves the desired effect and gets more views.

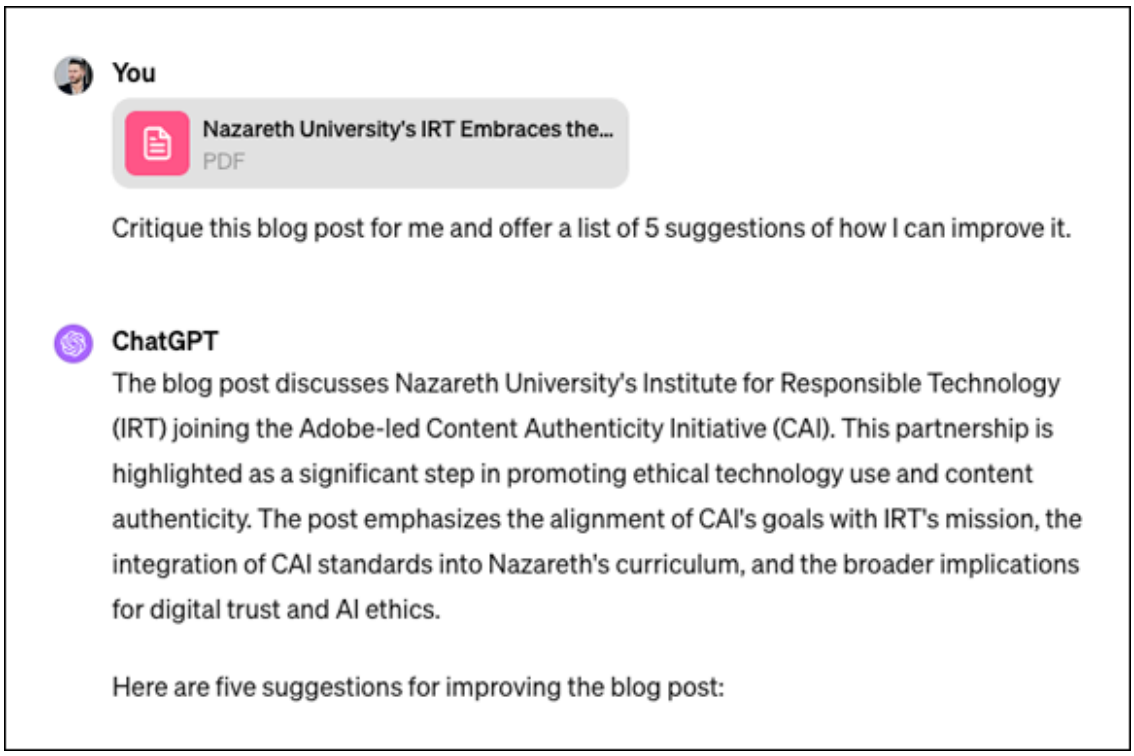


FIGURE 7-1: AI tools can make suggestions about improving written content like blog posts.



REMEMBER This shift in focus is crucial. It's about guiding AI to produce refined content and showcasing the copywriter's irreplaceable human insight with storytelling and audience understanding.

In other jobs, people are finding that AI can help them do their work in new ways. For example, in sales, AI can analyze customer data to help salespeople understand what their customers want.



TIP To adapt to these new career realities, start by learning about the AI tools and training in your field. We mention many of those resources throughout this book. Also, be open to new ways of doing your job. AI may change some parts of your work, but it also opens up new possibilities. Think of AI as something that adds to your skills, not something that

takes away from them. By learning to work with AI, you can make your job more interesting and do things you couldn't do before. It's about growing with the changes and using them to your advantage.

Shifting professional landscapes

The way in which individual roles are adapting to AI is part of a larger trend. It's not just about one job; it's about how AI is reshaping the whole world of work. Different industries are seeing traditional roles evolve. One great example is graphic designers transitioning into AI-aided user experience (UX)/user interface (UI) design, showing how AI tools can be a big help with their workflow.

Graphic designers, who are known for their artistic skills, are finding exciting new roles in UX/UI design, thanks to AI. These AI tools help them with automatic layout setups and color choices and even offer user experience ideas based on what people like and want. This means designers can spend more time on the creative parts of their job while AI handles the repetitive or data-focused tasks.

In marketing, AI is being used to figure out the best customers to target and to make smarter campaign plans. Marketers are now relying on AI for insights into customer behavior, which helps them create more effective marketing strategies.



REMEMBER Integrating AI into your work doesn't mean you're losing your job to a machine. Instead, it's about making your job easier and more efficient. AI acts like a tool that helps you focus on the parts of your job that really need your human skills and creativity.

Overall, moving from traditional roles to new AI-enhanced jobs will become the norm. It's an opportunity for people to grow in their careers and find new ways to work.

Steering clear of pitfalls

Moving to a new job where AI is integrated into almost everything can be challenging. It's important to know how to step into this new AI-powered role and hit the ground running. Here are some ideas to make job changes smoother, whether you have experience or you're just starting:

- **Know the technology.** Understand how you'll use AI in the job you want. This isn't just about the tech stuff; it's also about how AI changes the way you do the work. For example, in marketing, AI can sort through data, but you need people to make sense of it and plan what to do next.
- **Be flexible.** Being able to change and keep learning is important. Jobs with AI are changing rapidly, so be flexible and ready to learn new things.
- **Make connections.** Networking is key. Making connections with people in the field you want to work in can give you help, advice, and maybe even job leads. It's good to talk to others who have already made the career changes you want to make.
- **Be patient and realistic.** Changing jobs, especially to ones with AI, doesn't happen overnight. You may have to start at a lower level or take a sidestep to get where you want to be.
- **Keep your skills sharp.** Don't forget about skills like creativity and other soft skills. As AI does more of the technical work, these skills become even more important.
- **Ask for help.** It's okay to ask for advice. Career advisors, mentors, or courses can give you the advice and direction you need.

Becoming an Early Adopter

Next, we consider the idea of becoming an early adopter of new tech. We explore using AI proactively, not just because you have to, but to get ahead. Being one of the first to use new AI tech can cause people to see you as an *ideas* person — and that's a good thing!

Adopting new technologies

Using and experimenting with AI tech is important. Try out different software or tools in your job or even for fun. This will help you get better at them and let you see how they can help in your work. Here are a few examples of tools to consider:

- **ChatBot (`www.chatbot.com`):** ChatBot is an AI chatbot builder that allows businesses to create and implement conversational agents for customer service,

enhancing customer interaction and support.

- **ChatGPT (`https://openai.com/chatgpt`):** ChatGPT is a powerful GenAI chatbot that excels in generating text that is useful for content creation, automated customer service responses, and language translation.
- **Jasper (`www.jasper.ai`):** Jasper is an AI writing assistant that helps create high-quality content, from marketing copy to blog posts, enhancing productivity for content creators and marketers.
- **Synthesia (`www.synthesia.io`):** Synthesia is an AI video generation platform that creates realistic videos from text, useful for business presentations, training videos, and marketing, as shown in Figure 7-2.
- **Zapier (`https://zapier.com`):** Though not exclusively AI, Zapier automates workflows between various web applications, streamlining processes for businesses and increasing efficiency in tasks.

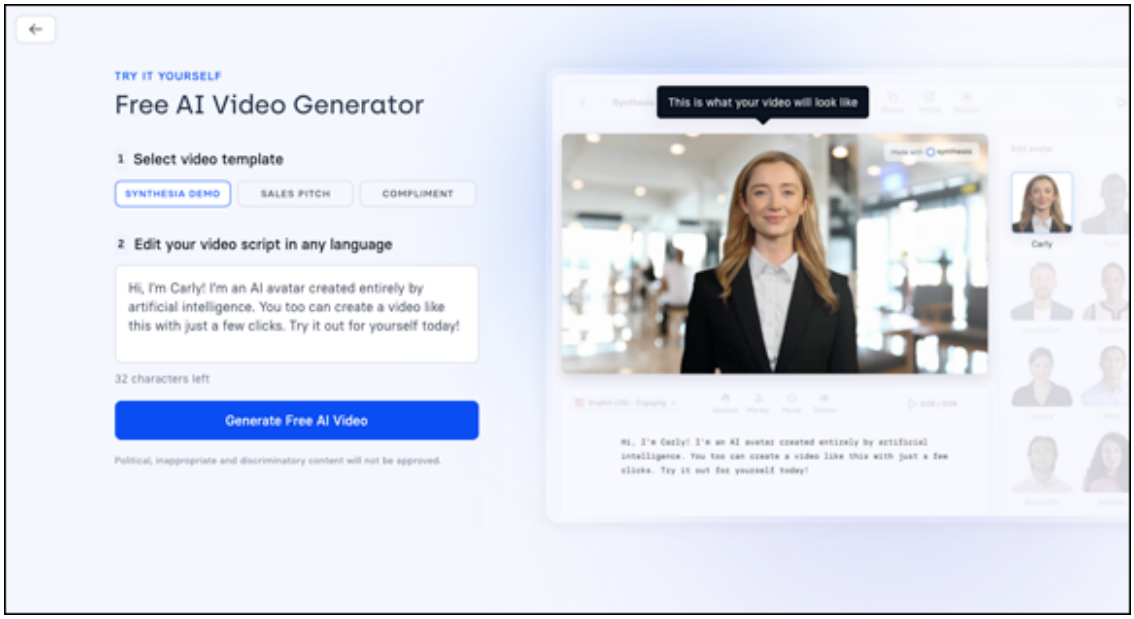


FIGURE 7-2: Synthesia lets you create complete videos from text prompts.

Trying new things, even if they don't always work out, is part of learning. Every time you try new things, you're likely to learn something new. Being ready to test, learn, and change is what makes someone good at using new tech.



TIP Keeping up with new tech, practicing it, talking with others about it, and being ready to try it out can really help you at work. It can make you a leader in using new tech and help you do your job better.

Utilizing AI for thought leadership

AI can play a key role in boosting thought leadership. By using AI, you can bring fresh ideas to the table and be perceived as a more advanced thought leader. Here are a few ways AI can advance your thought leadership:

- **AI gives you a massive amount of information and different perspectives quickly.** This information can spark new ideas that you may not have thought of on your own. For example, AI can analyze trends and data in your field, helping you see where things are going and what you should focus on.
- **AI helps you understand your audience better.** AI tools like data analysis platforms can show you what the public is interested in or worried about. This can help you create messages or content that really speaks to the concerns of your audience.
- **AI lets you test out your ideas quickly.** You can see what works and what doesn't without spending a lot of time or resources. This means you can try more new things and find the best ideas faster.

Gaining a competitive advantage through innovation

Adopting AI can give you a competitive advantage. It lets you do things in new and better ways. AI can look through lots of information quickly and find helpful insights. This can lead to new ideas, like different ways to talk to customers or solve problems that have been without a solution for a long time.



REMEMBER Being innovative isn't always about huge changes. Sometimes it's about making small improvements that make your work better and easier. AI can take care of routine tasks, so you have more time to think of new ideas and solve problems. Even small changes can make your work much better.

When you use AI with what you're already good at, you can come up with truly creative ideas. It isn't just about using AI tools; it's about making them a part of how you work. This helps you do new and exciting things.